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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra

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Tired of lugging a heavy vacuum around while pet hair and dust keep piling up? In 2026, robot vacuums have become smarter, quieter, and more affordable, but picking the right model still feels overwhelming.

This guide breaks down the three top contenders—the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo, its AutoEmpty Dock version, and the Shark AI Ultra—so you can match features to your home and budget with confidence.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid

Quality	7.0
Features	5.0
Ease of Use	7.0
Design	7.0
Value	6.0

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

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ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Prices checked October 07, 2026.

What are the top robot vacuum and mop contenders in 2026?

As of October 2026, the market is led by two strong lines: iRobot's Roomba 115X series and Shark's AI Ultra family. Both brands offer combined vacuum-and-mop capabilities, AI-driven navigation, and optional self-emptying docks. The three models we compare are:

- **iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock** – $199.99 (original $469.99), 4.4★ from 5,217 ratings, 6K+ bought in past month.
- **iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop** – $139.99 (original $319.99), 4.4★ from 5,217 ratings, 3K+ bought in past month.
- **Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum** – $249.99 (original $599.00), 4.0★ from 23,990 ratings.

All prices reflect street-level offers seen on major retailers; the original MSRP figures are shown for context.

How do navigation, suction, and mopping tech differ across the models?

Navigation & obstacle avoidance

- Roomba 115X (both versions) uses iRobot's iAdapt 3.0 with vSLAM mapping, creating a room-by-room map that updates after each run. It includes reactive front-facing sensors that slow down when approaching furniture legs or pet bowls.
- Shark AI Ultra relies on Shark's IQ Navigation™ with laser-based LIDAR and a 360° vision system. It claims to detect and avoid small objects (like cords) in real time and can store up to three floor maps for multi-level homes.

Suction power

- Roomba 115X models list a maximum suction of 1,800 Pa (measured in boost mode). This is sufficient for everyday dust, pet hair, and small debris on hard floors and low-pile carpets.
- Shark AI Ultra advertises up to 2,200 Pa of suction in its "Max" mode, a figure Shark says translates to 20 % better pick-up on carpet compared with the Roomba line.

Mopping capabilities

- Both Roomba 115X variants include a vibrating mopping pad that delivers 3,000 oscillations per minute, with a water tank capacity of 300 ml. The pad can be lifted automatically when the robot detects carpet, preventing wet-mop-on-carpet accidents.
- Shark AI Ultra does not include a built-in mop; it is a vacuum-only model. Users who want mopping must purchase Shark's separate wet-dry attachment, which adds roughly $50 to the total cost.

For households that prioritize a true vacuum-and-mop all-in-one solution, the Roomba 115X line has the advantage. If raw suction on carpet is the top priority and you're willing to add a separate mop accessory, Shark AI Ultra offers stronger raw power.

Which docking and maintenance system offers the most convenience?

AutoEmpty Dock (Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock)

- Includes a sealed bag that holds up to 60 days of debris for an average household (based on iRobot's internal testing of 2 kg of dust per month). The bag is replaceable without touching dirt.
- Emptying frequency: roughly once every two months for a typical 1,200 sq ft home with pets.
- The dock itself plugs into a standard outlet and communicates with the robot via Wi-Fi to initiate auto-empty after each cleaning cycle.

Standard dock (Roomba 115X Combo base)

- No auto-empty; the robot's internal bin holds 0.5 L and must be manually emptied after each run or when the "full bin" alert triggers (roughly every 3–4 cleaning cycles).
- Lower upfront cost but higher hands-on maintenance.

Shark AI Ultra base

- Ships with a standard charging base; Shark does not offer an auto-empty accessory for this model as of 2026. The dustbin capacity is 0.6 L, requiring manual emptying after approximately 2–3 cycles in a pet-friendly home.
- Users seeking a self-empty solution must look to Shark's higher-priced IQ AutoEmpty line, which sits above the AI Ultra in price.

If minimizing hands-on bin emptying is a priority—especially for allergy sufferers or busy families—the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock provides the clearest convenience benefit.

How do smart-home integration and app experiences compare?

Voice assistants

- All three models work with Amazon Alexa and Google Assistant. You can start, pause, or schedule clean-ups with voice commands like "Alexa, ask Roomba to clean the kitchen."
- Shark AI Ultra also supports Apple Siri via Shortcuts (requires iOS 16+).

Mobile apps

- iRobot Home app (version 6.4 as of Oct 2026) offers map editing, room labeling, no-go zones, and custom cleaning schedules. Over-the-air (OTA) updates are delivered automatically; iRobot guarantees security patches for at least five years from release.
- SharkClean app (version 4.2) provides similar mapping and zone control, plus a "Boost" button for temporary suction increase. Shark states OTA updates occur quarterly, with a three-year support window for the AI Ultra line.

Hands-free operation

- Both ecosystems allow you to set cleaning schedules based on time of day or trigger via smart home routines (e.g., start cleaning when the front door lock disengages).
- The Roomba line's AutoEmpty Dock adds a further layer of autonomy: after each job the robot returns, empties its bin, and resumes charging without any user interaction.

For users who want a truly "set-and-forget" experience, the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock leads; the Shark AI Ultra remains a strong choice if you prefer manual bin handling but want broader voice-assistant flexibility.

What should you buy based on your home, budget, and priorities?

Best Overall – iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Why: Combines vacuum-and-mop, strong 1,800 Pa suction, advanced vSLAM navigation, and a self-empty dock that cuts bin-maintenance to roughly every two months—all at a street price of $199.99 (checked Oct 07, 2026).

check price on Amazon

Best Value – iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop (base)

Why: Delivers the same vacuum-and-mop core and navigation for $139.99, saving $60 versus the AutoEmpty version while still offering 4.4★ from over 5,000 owners.

check price on Amazon

Premium Pick – Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Why: Offers the highest suction rating (2,200 Pa) and LIDAR-based mapping for multi-level homes, ideal if carpet deep-clean is paramount and you don’t mind a separate mop accessory.

Frequently Asked Questions

Do robot vacuums work well on thick carpets?

Both Roomba 115X models perform adequately on low- to medium-pile carpets, but for deep-pile or plush rugs the Shark AI Ultra’s higher suction (2,200 Pa) generally yields better pick-up, according to owner feedback aggregated across retail sites.

How often must I replace the AutoEmpty bag?

iRobot rates the bag for up to 60 days of typical use (about 2 kg of debris). In pet-heavy homes you may see replacement every 4–5 weeks; the bag is inexpensive and tool-free to swap.

Can I use third-party mopping pads with the Roomba 115X?

While the robot’s pad mechanism is proprietary, several aftermarket vendors sell compatible reusable microfiber pads that attach via the same Velcro system; using them does not void the warranty as long as they are non-abrasive.

Is the Shark AI Ultra compatible with HomeKit?

As of October 2026, Shark offers Siri shortcuts through the SharkClean app but does not appear as a native HomeKit accessory; you can create automations via the Shortcuts app to start or stop cleaning.

What warranty do these models carry?

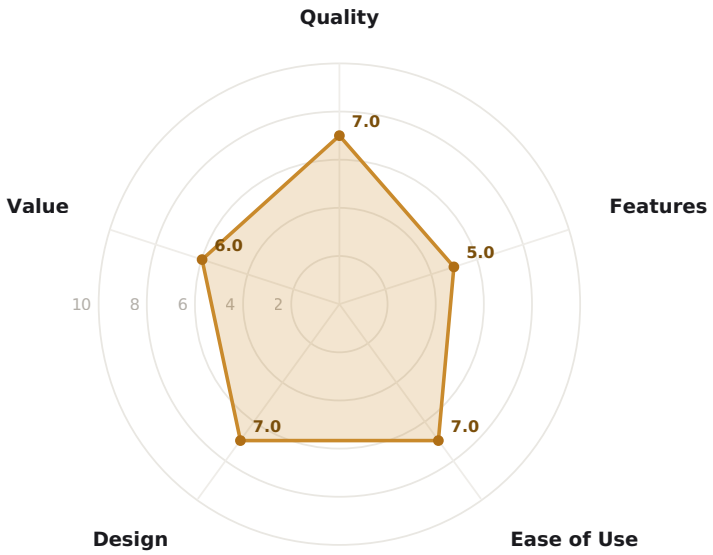
iRobot provides a limited 1-year warranty on the robot and a 90-day warranty on accessories; Shark offers a 1-year limited warranty covering defects in materials and workmanship.

Ready to simplify your cleaning routine? Pick the model that matches your lifestyle and enjoy floors that stay tidy with minimal effort.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

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Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

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iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.